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IMPERATIVE BUSINESS VENTURES LIMITED

Business Continuity Plan

Document Control chart.

Document Name	BUSINESS CONTINUITY PLAN
Version	1.0
Created on	April 2022
Created by	Kunal Pawar, Sr System Admin
Reviewed by	Ketan Shete, Director, Technology & Customer Success
Next Revision	30th April 2026
Document Approved by	Aman Gujar, Director - IT, InfoSec & Product Development

Document Revision chart.

Date	Version	Reviewed by	Changes
30th April 2022	1.0	Director - IT, InfoSec & Product Development	No changes
30th April 2023	1.0	Director - IT, InfoSec & Product Development	No changes
30th April 2024	1.0	Director - IT, InfoSec & Product Development	No changes
30th April 2025	1.0	Director - IT, InfoSec & Product Development	No changes

Business Continuity Plan

1. Objective

To design a framework for activation of a Business Continuity Plan (BCP) in a situation of disaster. A disaster is defined as "any unplanned event that results in the inability of the business to support operations in whole or in part". A business is vulnerable to four different types of disaster:

- Natural disasters
- Willful damage
- Accidental damage
- Global Pandemic

To minimize the damage to business by such an occurrence, it is necessary to have a recovery plan, which addresses the worst-case scenario. Hence objective is to design a framework to enable Work from Home for Contact Centre agents to support BCP.

In scope:

Banking operations across all businesses operating from the Partner sites for IBVL Processes.

2. Communication and Enablement

IT Management Group

Partner to form a body of IT Management Group. The IT Management Group is responsible for controlling all technical aspects of emergency response. The group will be led by the Authorized Person. Members of this group (and only these designated members) have the authority to:

- Order facility shutdown
- Initiate evacuation of employees and customers
- Declare that an incident has Started / Ended
- Communicate with respective stakeholders
- Activate & execute BCP plan

3. Context of Operational Risks

In the backdrop of growing complexity of financial products and the increased leveraging of technology and its heightened sophistication, operational risks have assumed critical importance in recent times. The treatment of operational risks as a distinct risk category along with credit and market risks in the Basel II framework is a manifestation of the vital role played by operational risks in impacting risk profile of an IBVL. Operational risks can also have a systemic connotation in the event of contagion through channels like the payment system and undermine public confidence in the banking system.

4. Importance of BCP

Business Continuity Planning is a key pre-requisite for minimizing the adverse effects of one of the important areas of operational risk – business disruption and system failures. A recent study

conducted by RBI revealed that some BFSI were still in the process of framing a Business Continuity Plan (BCP). It is imperative that IBVL will have BCPs in place to be in readiness to tackle serious business disruptions.

5. Governance Responsibility

The responsibility in respect of BCP rests with the Board of Directors and the top management of IBVL. The Board will provide top management clear guidance and direction in relation to BCP. The Board fulfils its responsibilities by:

- Approving policy on BCP
- Prioritizing critical business functions
- Allocating sufficient resources
- Reviewing BCP test results
- Ensuring maintenance and periodic updating of BCP

The BCP requirements enunciated in this circular will be considered as a minimum. The onus is on the Board and the top management for generating detailed components of BCP in the light of individual bank's activities, systems and processes. The top management is responsible for executing such a BCP if contingency arises. The top management will annually review the adequacy of the institution's business recovery, contingency plans and the test results and put the same to the Board. The top management will also evaluate the adequacy of contingency planning and their periodic testing by service providers whenever critical operations are outsourced.

6. Business Interdependencies

Changing business processes (internally to the institution and externally among interdependent financial service providers) and new threat scenarios require maintenance of viable BCPs. An effective BCP will take into account:

- The potential for wide disasters that impact an entire region and for the resulting loss or inaccessibility of staff
- Interdependencies, both market-based and geographic, among financial system participants as well as infrastructure service providers

7. Timeline and Testing

It is, therefore, advised that IBVL will put in place a BCP including a robust information risk management system, if not already implemented, within a fixed time frame. They will implement such BCP and thoroughly test it to verify its full capability against the changing scenario and assumptions at frequent intervals, as per the policy. The plan will also be subjected to review annually.

8. BCP Methodology Will Include:

- Identification of critical businesses, owned and shared resources with supporting functions (the BCP template shall include IT Continuity Plan template)
- Structured risk assessment based on comprehensive Business Impact Analysis (BIA)
- Formulating Recovery Time Objectives (RTO) based on BIA, periodically fine-tuned by benchmarking against industry best practices

- Critical and tough assumptions in terms of disaster so that the framework would be exhaustive enough to address the most stressful situations
- Identification of the Recovery Point Objective (RPO) for data loss for each of the critical systems and strategy to deal with such data loss
- Alternate procedures during the time systems are not available
- Clearly documented and tested processes for shifting to secondary/back-up systems and sites
- Risk management by implementing IS design and architecture to attain the bank's agreed RTOs and RPOs

Also includes:

- Minimizing immediate damage and losses
- Restoring critical business functions, including customer-facing systems and payment & settlement systems like cash disbursements, ATMs, Internet banking, call centers, etc.
- Establishing management succession and emergency powers
- Addressing HR issues and training aspects
- Providing for the safety and wellbeing of people in the branch or at the location at the time of the disaster
- Use of external resources/support
- Having specific contingency plans for each outsourcing arrangement based on the degree of materiality of the outsourced activity to the bank's business
- Ensuring service providers for critical operations have BCPs in place and also periodically test the same
- Compatibility and co-ordination of contingency plans at both the bank and its service providers
- Action plans, practical manuals and testing procedures
- Independent audit and review of the BCP and test results
- Periodic updating to absorb changes in the institution or its service providers

9. Plan Development and Dissemination

The BCP will consider the project management procedures, change management process, data center process, backup and recovery process. Based on a sound methodology, a development plan for the DRS / BCP will be initiated. The plan needs to be continuously evaluated and revised whenever the bank forays into new business tools and areas, either as part of a reengineering process or for introducing new products and services.

The relevant portion of the BCP adopted will also be disseminated to all concerned, including the customers, so that the awareness would enable them to react positively and in consonance with the BCP. The part of the plan kept in the public domain will normally be confined to information relating to the general readiness of the IBVL in this regard without any detailed specifics.

10. Cost Implication

BCP involves cost implications. While IBVL will consider cost-effective strategies for BCP, the strategies considered will provide an adequate level of comfort and assurance in tackling serious disruptions.

Moreover, the mitigating solution will be commensurate with the nature and complexity of their business operations.

11. Insurance as a Risk Mitigation Strategy

BVPL will also consider insurance as a risk mitigation strategy for externalizing risks to third parties to reduce financial exposure in the event of disruption. However, diligence needs to be exercised regarding the nature of insurance and the certainty of payments.

12. BCP Activation Framework on Partner Technology

Work from Home Framework	Owner	Timeline
Call Center Assets to be provided at agents and support staff's resident /Preferred Location during BCP Situation (Designated desktop to be provided to agents)	Partner	24-48 hrs.
Call Center Assets to be provided at agents and support staffs' residences/Preferred Location during BCP Situation	Partner	24-48 hrs.
Partner technology: - Domain to be extended to agents' location	IBVL/Partner	Immediate
Partner technology: - Domain to be extended to agents' location	Partner	24-48 hrs.

IBVL Banking Operations Assets:

- Computer / Laptop
- Post Paid / Prepaid Dongles / Alternate Internet connectivity
- Headset to take calls
- Keyboard, Mouse, etc.

Recovery and Restoration

Once BCP is disabled, the Partner IT Management Group to ensure reboot of operational site(s) within next 24–48 hrs.

BCP Activation Framework on IBVL technology

IBVL Technology: - Domain to be extended to agents' location	IBVL/Partner	Immediate
Activation of all Agents on Work from home Platform	Partner	24-48 hrs.

IBVL Banking Operations Assets:

- Computer / Laptop
- Post Paid / Prepaid Dongles
- Headset to take calls
- Keyboard, Mouse, etc.

Recovery and Restoration

Once BCP is disabled, the Partner IT Management Group to ensure reboot of operational site(s) within next 48 hrs.

13. Testing

- The Business Continuity Plan should be periodically verified, validated and tested through mock BCP once in 3 months and covering minimum of 10% of the overall staffing at the respective location.
- Mock BCP's documentation and report-outs to be shared with IBVL.
- The same is subject to on-site/Remote audit.

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